

Nickolas Stricker

Solutions Engineer | Sales Engineer | Senior Full-Stack Engineer

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SUMMARY

Sales engineer and senior full-stack engineer with 6+ years closing the gap between technical complexity and business outcomes. I run client demo calls with enterprise customers at Expocad, demo live at national trade shows, and turn what customers ask for into scoped engineering work. As founder of Stricker Digital, I own the technical thread of every deal from discovery to demo, proof of concept, close, and delivery, driving 24-43% conversion gains measured with GA4. I build POCs fast, answer security and integration questions from hands-on experience, and take the technical load off AEs. AWS Solutions Architect certified.

SKILLS

Technical Discovery and Pre-Sales: Discovery calls, requirements gathering, pain-to-solution mapping, tailored demos, POC and prototype development, objection handling, technical evaluations, voice of the customer to product

Security and Integrations: PCI-compliant infrastructure, IAM, OAuth 2.0 and API authentication, REST APIs, webhooks, third-party integrations (Clover, Square, Converge, ChatGPT), CompTIA Security+ in progress

Cloud and Data: AWS Solutions Architect certified (Lambda, EC2, S3, CloudFront, Lightsail), static IP configuration, CI/CD, SQL and relational data modeling, analytics pipelines, GA4

Development: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, Java, C#, Tailwind CSS; Jira

AI and Prototyping: Claude Code and Codex daily with context-first prompting and full code review, ~5x feature velocity; ChatGPT API in production SaaS; agentic workflow design with LLM orchestration and tool use

EXPERIENCE

Expocad by A.C.T | Aurora, IL | Senior Full-Stack Engineer (Acting Tech Lead) May 2021 - Present

- Lead client demo calls with enterprise customers: walk them through the platform, field technical and business process questions, and turn their requests into scoped requirements.
- Deliver in-person demos at national trade shows annually to show managers, exhibitors, and enterprise clients, covering booth rental workflows, interactive floor plans, and contract completion.
- Translate customer feedback into engineering tickets in Jira, assign work across the team, and validate every ticket before moving it to done, acting as the feedback loop between customers and engineering.
- Improved application performance 30% by profiling and optimizing SQL queries, API data flows, and UI in a 900,000-line codebase.
- Reduced user friction 22% by mining support ticket trends and usage data to find friction hotspots.
- Architected and shipped a real-time attendee dashboard from scratch (React, Node.js, REST APIs, SQL, live webhook messaging with chat, file uploads, and group channels). Still live and growing.
- Mentored junior engineers and rolled out an AI-assisted development workflow for the team (Claude Code and Codex with line-by-line review).

Stricker Digital | Chicago, IL | Founder / Solutions Engineer Aug 2025 - Present

- Ran the full cycle for RedtailLuxe, a luxury watch retailer: discovery surfaced trust gaps and checkout friction, then demos and a proof of concept closed the deal in about a month, followed by a 30% conversion lift in month one.
- Lead technical discovery on every engagement, assessing current-state architecture, business goals, pain points, and budget before proposing a solution.
- Design and pitch solution architectures (React/Next.js, Node.js/REST APIs, AWS, third-party integrations), explaining tradeoffs like payment security and SEO in plain language that wins buy-in.
- Built a multi-tenant SaaS e-commerce platform on Next.js and AWS serving multiple live clients, with Clover, Square, and Converge payments, OAuth 2.0 authentication, and AI admin tools.
- Designed and deployed PCI-compliant AWS infrastructure, including static IP configuration and payment processor authentication; learned Lightsail in one week to launch a florist's Converge integration before Valentine's Day.
- Drove 24-43% conversion gains across client projects, instrumenting GA4 up front on every engagement to measure outcomes and prove ROI.
- Built the pipeline from scratch with 2,000+ cold calls and a Gemini research workflow that cut prospect research from 30 minutes to under 2.

Bloom Institute of Technology | Remote | Teaching Assistant 2020 - 2021

- Mentored 10+ students through an 18-month full-stack bootcamp, explaining technical concepts until they clicked.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Amazon Web Services: Certified Solutions Architect Associate

CompTIA Security+: In Progress

Google: Digital Marketing and E-Commerce Professional Certificate

Bloom Institute of Technology: Full Stack Web Developer + Computer Science Certificate